



Closeout Report: Tablet Rollout

Project Summary

- The Sauce & Spoon Tablet Rollout project involved the integration and launch of digital menu tablets across our restaurant locations to modernize the guest experience and improve operational efficiency. The primary goal of the project was to successfully implement the tablet system while maintaining brand alignment, accelerating table turnover, and increasing daily guest counts without sacrificing customer satisfaction.

Methodology

This project utilized a **hybrid project management approach**, blending traditional planning with iterative, agile-inspired adjustments based on real-world data.

- **Pilot Testing Phase (Agile/Iterative):** Before a full-scale deployment, a test launch was executed with a 50-customer pilot group to gather immediate user survey metrics.
- **Data-Driven Adjustments:** Continuous improvement cycles were implemented mid-project. When pilot data indicated that initial benchmarks were missed, the project team paused to troubleshoot UI layouts, establish waitstaff tracking checklists, and retrain employees before completing the final rollout.

Results

Performance Baseline:

	Planned	Actual	Notes
Actual Project Schedule vs Planned	Launch on Apr. 23	Launched on Apr. 23	We were able to launch on the day we wanted, but had to accelerate our

			tasks due to delays
Actual Project Cost vs Planned	Training materials and fees: \$10,000 Hardware and software implementation across locations: \$3,500 Maintenance (IT fees): \$5,000 Updated website and menu design fee: \$5,000 Other customization fees: \$550	Training materials and fees: \$7,486 Hardware and software implementation across locations: \$3,600 annually Maintenance (IT fees): \$0 (included with hardware order subscription) Updated website and menu design fee: \$4,250 Other customization fees: \$578	Overall, we nearly matched our budget
Planned Scope vs Delivered Scope	Install tablets at two restaurant locations Launch at the beginning of Q2 (April 1) Create a plan for how to train staff on the new system	Physically installed tablets at two restaurant locations via electrician Added menus, coupons, branding, and additional content to tablets Integrated tablets with POS system Negotiated with tablet vendor over timing Created a plan for training Managed waitstaff expectations and concerns Trained BOH and FOH Created system for maintenance/locking Implemented system of surveying and measuring customer satisfaction	We didn't realize how many moving pieces we were going to encounter

Key Accomplishments:

- The Downtown location achieved a 20% increase in daily guest counts, doubling the initial goal of 10%.
- Table turn times were successfully reduced by **30 minutes**, leading to significantly shorter wait times for arriving guests.
- Validated that the average tablet checkout duration successfully remained at **one minute or less**.
- Collaborated closely with the kitchen staff to successfully meet the target of a **25% reduction in**

food waste.

- Introduced a new pre-service testing checklist that successfully dropped weekly reported technical glitches to **under 5%**.

Lessons Learned

- Guests highly enjoyed the novelty of the tablets and the brand-specific videos. The system successfully accelerated table pacing and transaction speeds once stabilized.
- The initial tablet navigation layout was too complex; 22% of pilot customers explicitly rated the navigation as difficult or slightly difficult.
- The checkout system lacked clear payment messaging. Digital surveys and general manager feedback revealed that cash-paying customers (who make up roughly 10% of our customer base) suffered a slow, clumsy checkout process because waitstaff had to walk all the way to the bar register to manually process cash transactions.
- During the pilot, 12% of users experienced freezing screens or system glitches, which disrupted their dining flow.

Next Steps

- Maintain ongoing syncs with Carter and the kitchen staff to monitor ticket errors and verify that the 25% food waste reduction remains stable.
- Continue using the pre-service testing checklist to track tablet degradation, battery health, and system freezes.
- For future locations, if a restaurant layout relies on a single cash register located far from the floor (like the bar-only setup), cash-paying guests will continue to experience friction.
- Before rolling out tablets at a new location, evaluate the physical floor plan. Consider adding a secondary cash register near the kitchen pass-through to minimize server travel time for cash transactions.

Project Documentation Archive

- [Project Proposal](#)
- [Project Charter](#)
- [Project Plan](#)
- [Evaluation findings](#)